Dark Is Her Magic (But Not Her Heart)

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Dark Is Her Magic (But Not Her Heart)

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Summary

Every Horde recruit knows the story of how Hordak landed in Bright Moon and Queen Angella gave the Horde her Moonstone in exchange for his help unifying the people of Etheria. Problem is, the Etherians don't seem to want unifying, viewing the Horde as less of a benevolent savior and more of an occupying force.
Hence, war broke loose.
The Horde has superior technology, but the other princesses wield powerful magic, allied with an army of sorcerers super-charged by the Spell of Obtainment. Yet a new princess emerges to break the stalemate: a golden warrior out of legend known as She-Ra.

Bright Moon is the eye of the storm and no one's sure what the truth is, especially since the Queen disappeared shortly after King Micah, leaving Bright Moon's princess alone and unchecked save for her best and only friend: a tech savvy orphan named Bow who serves as Hordak's apprentice.

But power, both political and mystical, has transformed Glimmer until Bow's not sure he recognizes his best friend anymore.
Under Castaspella's ruthless tutelage, the young queen has mastered forbidden dark magics, The Horde's only hope of countering She-Ra and the dangerous Light Spinner, the enemy's most powerful sorceress…

Notes

Many thanks for my alpha reader Series-Shipper, and my beta reader Gloria, who helped me turn this fic into what it is now, from providing ideas, to detailed feedback that polished the rather sharp/uncomfortable to read edges XD

I enjoyed writing this so much! I even wrote it faster than I thought because of how hype I was lol

And ofc, many many thanks Tippen for pspsps-ing me into writing for your art, holy damn (>^<)

I hope you enjoy this little story I cooked with your summary, and well, same goes for everyone reading this!! :D

BUT, I also want to let you know that I had to make a literal POLL to choose the title for this XD
These are the options that lost:

- Dark is the magic (in this place)
- Dark is the magic (and heavy the crown)
- Dark is her magic
- Heavy is the crown that’s always hidden

Now, yes! Please enjoy!!

See the end of the work for more notes

- Inspired by Glimbow Horde Lords AU Fananrt by TippenFunkaport

Now

Bow began pulling from the solid green metal plates.

It made his muscles burn, but finally he managed to pull one out, revealing the beautiful white marble underneath.

He would tear down all the Horde scrap metal, even if he had to do so by hand, piece by piece.

He would restore Bright Moon's palace…

The more he went over what he had always known, what he had been *told*, the more his determination grew.

Thinking about it, every Horde recruit knows the story of how Hordak landed in Bright Moon and Queen Angella gave the Horde her Moonstone in exchange for his help unifying the people of Etheria.

But the Etherians never wanted such unification, did they?

No, they viewed the Horde as less of a benevolent savior and more of an occupying force.

Maybe they had always been right.

After all, no one's ever been sure of what the truth was, especially since the Queen disappeared shortly after King Micah…

Well, he's sure now.

He knows the truth, and that's why he has to do this.

However, before he could take down more of the metal covering the walls, someone stormed into the throne room.

—What do you think you're doing!?

He would recognize that voice anywhere.

—I don't want to fight you, Glimmer— he said, hands raised, as a plea.

—Then don't do it! Stay by my side! Don't abandon me now!

—Look around you, Glim! Is this the throne room you grew up in!?— he asked, holding his ground, refusing to yield.

Searching for his friend under the ruthless Horde Lord.

—It is *my* throne room!

—No, it is not! It's the Horde's! It's Hordak's throne! *Your* throne was made of a beautiful gold that glistened with the sun— he recalled, visualizing the once regal throne where the current one stood.

—Don’t you want it back!? Don’t you want your mother’s legacy to rule once again!?

—That’s what I’m doing!— Glimmer scoffed, looking menacing yet far from summoning her powers. —Why are you getting in the way!?

—I am not! *You* are not doing what you think! I- Glim, listen to me— he begged, stepping closer. —You’re following Hordak’s path, not Angella’s…

—What could *you* know about my mother!?

—Enough to realize this is wrong! I know it now… we were *lied to*.

—Bullshit!

—It is not! Look around you! This is *not* your palace! The original palace lays underneath all this scrap metal!— Bow exclaimed, infuriated.

—No! That’s only the-the last vestiges of the Princesses!

—Glimmer, *you* are a Princess!

—Not like them!— she growled back, her fists sparking to life with her powers.

—No… You’re not…— he admitted, in a low tone, looking at the purple glow around her hands. —Because you’re not even the Glimmer I know. *My friend* would never… threaten me.

With that, her angry expression melted away.

What was she doing?

This… wasn’t *her*!

She would never treat Bow like this!

Why was she…

Oh, of course.

It was all *her* fault.

Her so-called *Aunt*…

And speaking of her…

Castaspella was alone in her chamber, pulling out an arrow from her arm.

That damned kid, Bow…

He had figured it out and *suddenly* wanted to be “a good man” or something!?

She could hardly believe he managed to land an arrow on her…

Well, but he had, and it hurt like the absolute *worst*!

Nothing some black magic couldn't fix in a moment, of course…

As she rinsed the blood off her skin in front of the mirror, her sight lingered on the multiple scars running through her body.

"A good man"…

As if it were so simple…

Well, perhaps for him it was. But for her!?

He had told her to "stop this madness" and "make things right", as if he *knew* what any of that meant!

No, there's no turning back now, Kid…

But Glimmer was handling him, wasn't she?

Her obedient niece…

So it was time for her to make sure all her efforts wouldn't go to waste.

She was sure Bow must have brought the Princess Alliance into Bright Moon… which meant *she* would show up any time now.

Light Spinner.

She could *not* let her ruin everything she had achieved with Glimmer.

What Castaspella wouldn't have imagined, however, was that the sorceress wasn't looking for her niece…

She was thinking about casting the pulse spell to find Light Spinner, when she heard a gasp and saw the woman standing at the entrance of the chamber.

—Well, that makes things easier for me— Castaspella smirked, facing her and wrapping her wounded arm with a make-shift bandage of black magic.

The Head Sorceress of Mystacor looked away for a second before letting out —You actually let it consume you?

—Don't you dare patronize me— she replied, indignant. Approaching, she dared her —If you want to get to Glimmer, you'll have to get through me first. But we both know you *can't*.

—Don't do this, Castaspella…

—You don't tell me what to do!

Her voice rang through the whole chamber and Light Spinner flinched, scared.

—Just… why are you…

—I'm not answering your questions— Castaspella interrupted. —I wasn't expecting to see you so afraid, but that works… As long as I give Glimmer enough time, she'll put out your petty attack force, and you'll become our prisoner— she smirked.

—There's no… attack force— Light Spinner told her, serious, in high alert, and seemingly less proud than usual.

Castaspella was sure that had to be a tactic to confuse her.

—Sure…

—I'm telling the truth. Bow wanted to do this the right way. We are not here for her.

—"We"?

—I didn't come alone, Castaspella, and I didn't come for the Princess. I'm here for you— she said. —*He* is here for you both…

He?

—No… Liar!— the dark sorceress yelled. —*He* is gone, and it's *your fault*!

—He is *not* gone, you know that well!

—If he weren't, he'd have returned for me far earlier— Castaspella hissed.

—He was looking for a way to save you from the corruption… But it wasn't… nearly as bad back then— Light Spinner insisted, looking pained now.

—Don't— she barked. —Don't start with your *lies*!

—I may have lied many times before, but I am not lying now!

That was enough.

As dark magic began oozing like a black liquid from Castaspella's hands, she let out —I will get rid of you before you take Glimmer from me…

—Casta!?

The sorceress looked past Light Spinner, who hadn't made a move to protect herself or attack either, and felt numb upon being met with the same brown eyes she has.

—Micah?

The black magic vanished for a second as she hesitated, questioning herself.

Light Spinner wasn't lying.

And yet, immediately after, she looked at him with rage, and *shoot*.

—No!

The Head Sorceress got in the middle, raising a shield, and Micah had to force himself out of the shock to join his mentor and hold the shield against the might of Castaspella's attack.

—Please, stop! It's me!

—Oh, I *know* it's you! *Traitor*!

—*You* are the traitor!— Micah yelled back. —What have you done!? Why get Glimmer involved!?

—You *abandoned* us!— Castaspella insisted, joining her hands to strengthen the stream of black magic trying to pierce their shield.

—I did not! I escaped from Hordak!

—Lies!

—You know it's true!

With a scream, Castaspella gave it her all until her attack shattered the shield, and both Light Spinner and Micah were knocked back.

She approached, slowly, step by step, preparing a new attack, and towered over them.

—Send Angella my regards— she let out, raising her hand.

And then the room went bright for a moment.

Someone screamed.

Glimmer had appeared, and now her aunt was on the ground, a few meters away from Light Spinner and Micah, right under a window.

—You lied to me!— she began, striding closer to Castaspella. —Didn't you!?

—Glimmer?

—Dad!?— she noticed, immediately turning around and blinking closer to him, forgetting everything else. —Dad…— she sobbed, hugging him tightly.

Light Spinner was still a bit dizzy, but seeing them reunited was a relief.

The boy was right…

—Ah… so I lied, didn't I?— Castaspella uttered, pushing herself up from the ground. —And now they are back to save the day, and I lose… again…— she went on, standing up.

—Casta, wait, you never had to…

—Yes, I had!— she barked, interrupting her brother. —But worry not, Micah. That won't be a problem anymore.

—What?— he uttered, confused and feeling as if he was missing something *important*.

What he couldn't catch, was maybe the maddened glisten in his sister's eyes.

Or the coldness of the air as the temperature suddenly dropped…

Or that glance, a bit too quick to notice.

—No, wait!— Light Spinner yelled, realizing what she was going to do.

With a wicked smirk, Castaspella took a step back, then another, and leant back against nothing, letting herself fall out of the window.

Back then

Bright Moon's palace had become quite dark since the Queen's disappearence.

The lights, the colours, the plants… everything had been gone for so long that Glimmer no longer missed it.

She had become used to the darkness, barely illuminated by electric lights of a sickly green colour.

So she didn't even think about it while resting on one knee and looking down as she reported to her tutor.

—There's a new princess— Glimmer began. —Her power is like nothing we've seen before. She's even more powerful than Light Spinner and her sorcerers.

—Is she?

—It's like-like the sun itself— she went on, never looking up. —Her powers are something we've only ever seen in tales. And she does look… like the She-Ra of those legends you told me.

—Then what are you going to do?

—What I should have done long ago— Glimmer replied, with a smirk curling her lips. —I'll overthrow that old man and take the throne. I'll make that new princess crawl back to her hiding spot— she went on, slowly standing up. Finally, she looked up as she concluded —I'll take the throne and set things right, Auntie.

Meanwhile, Bow remained outside the room, hearing everything, expression determined.

Yes, they would set things right.

They had to overthrow Hordak…

He didn't know if he had the heart to do that to his own mentor, but… he *knew* this was Glimmer's birthright.

Maybe he could… talk things first?

No, no. Glimmer already told him that wouldn't work.

However, was it really so necessary to keep using that dark magic Castaspella taught her?

Glimmer wasn't visibly corrupted yet, not like her aunt at least, but he couldn't shake the feeling that something just… wasn't right.

He only hoped that, once she recovered her rightful place as the Queen of Bright Moon, she would, maybe, leave behind that dark magic stuff.

So it started small.

Bow handled the most subtle aspects, all the preparation, talking to cadets and officers…

Convincing everyone of how inoperative Hordak was.

Everyone agreed that he seemed to be making no progress, the war had been at a stalemate for a while, and now with the new princess, they were actually *losing*.

Furthermore, most conversations ended with praises to Glimmer and the great promise she showed.

It was going just *perfect*.

Then, the second phase of the plan was her duty.

Stealthily, she began sabotaging Hordak's weapons and anything that may remotely cause discomfort among soldiers.

Soon, everyone was actively asking for Hordak to step down and let Glimmer take command.

So it was time for the final push: an authority figure endorsing Angella's daughter.

Knowing they would have the whole support of the soldiers and officers of all ranks, Bow accompanied Glimmer to see her aunt.

—Is it time?

—Everything is ready. With your endorsement, we can finally overthrow Hordak and take control of the Horde.

—Well done, my Dear— Castaspella smirked. —Then we shall do it tonight.

—Why wait, Auntie? We can do it right now.

—Patience, Glimmer. Most soldiers are currently out on missions. We need everyone here to make sure the manpower will be available if Hordak were to… *resist*.

—Right, yes— she nodded. —Then we'll wait.

—Don't let there be any rumours until nightfall— Castaspella ordered. —If he were to learn about this too soon, we'd lose the element of surprise.

—We'll handle it, Auntie— Glimmer smirked, before vowing and leaving the chamber.

Outside, Bow met her.

She looked… more evil than usual.

—Everything alright?

—Tonight, we'll finally take control— Glimmer told him, proud. —But we can't let any rumours out until nightfall.

—Alright— he nodded. —And then… once you take the throne, we'll set things right… Right?— he then asked.

—Of course, Bow!

—I trust you, Glim— he smiled, taking her hand. —We'll do this together.

—Together— she nodded. —I'll make my parents proud— she promised. —But for now, I want to put some food in my belly, so come with me— she laughed, pulling him to the dining room.

As they ate together, Bow couldn't help daydreaming about how things would change, and recalled a bit how that place used to be. How he hoped it'd be again.

Before Angella disappeared, everything was so different… Even the war.

Then Micah went missing, a little after, the Queen too… and Hordak didn't hesitate to make the whole place look… well, like the inside of the space ship in which he arrived.

The memories were fading, but Bow was almost sure the palace used to have colours ranging from white to pink, some gold here and there, tones of blue, even greenery…

Sometimes, he tried to reminiscence with Glimmer but, more often than not, she would get upset and he didn't like seeing her upset in the slightest.

Yet it was always because, in her own words, he made her long for something she couldn't have.

Well, they would be in charge soon enough! Maybe they could restore the palace!

—Hey, Glim… Have you thought what you're going to do once… you know…

—Oh, I have a whole plan!— she replied, excited to speak about it. —I've presented Auntie so many plans and *finally* she's accepted the last one I proposed!

—So?

—I'm doing something about the cadet training. And the weaponry needs specialized teams, *and* we're going to start looking for potential sorcerers to train!

—Oh… Alright, that's- What-what about the place? The palace?

—What about it?

—I mean, remember we talked about…

—Oh, that? Nah, forget it, Bow. That's irrelevant.

—I think it's important— he insisted. Looking away, he pointed out —This is all Hordak's signature. To make it more you, I think restoring how it used to be would be a good idea…

—It is strategically irrelevant— Glimmer rebuked.

—Strategically… I see— he sighed. —Does that mean… you'll… keep using black magic?

—Why would I *ever* leave it!?— she scoffed, laughing.

—No, well, I mean…

—Bow, what is it? Are you hesitant because… you know, Hordak's your mentor, and all that…

—Yea- No- Well… I don't know…— he lied.

He *knew* what his problem was.

He missed the old Glimmer. The girl she used to be when her mother was around.

Before Castaspella took over and completely twisted her!

—Bow…— she called, taking his hands between hers. —I'm still me. And you are still you. What matters is that we stay together! Always there for each other! I won't abandon you, no matter what!

—And if your aunt told you I have to be disposed of?— he asked, looking away.

—No, she wouldn't- E-even if she said so, I'd find a way to keep you.

—Thanks, Glim— he replied, with a sad smile.

Perhaps there was still a bit of the Glimmer he knew…

That night, Hordak fled.

With the overwhelming majority of the Horde, if not everyone, supporting Glimmer's claim to the throne, he had no choice.

Thinking he'd be executed, he went to the only "neutral" kingdom that may remotely decide to grant him refuge: Dryl.

But Glimmer didn't want to go after him.

No. She simply took the throne, reveled on her new role as Lord of the Horde, and named Bow Head of Technology.

She said they were now the leaders together… As they wanted. But then, why did he feel… so *wrong*?

He had so many questions…

—I don't understand why you're still agonizing over this…

—Glim, it's just…— he began, but trailed off. "Just" what!? He couldn't let her know he didn't recognize her anymore! She'd go insane! She'd think he was going to abandon her! —I-I mean, there are things I thought would change now, with you in charge.

—*Us* in charge!— Glimmer corrected him. —And yes! A lot is changing! You call the shots too, Bow. So, tell me, what do you want to do?

—I…

—Anything, just say the word and you can do it, I'll make sure you get all the help necessary.

Is some greenery too much to ask?

—I want to… scout the Whispering Woods— he said, tentatively. —I want to go with a few soldiers, take samples, we can better study the magic…

—Oh, that would be great!— Glimmer beamed. —You can help me and Auntie with proper magical studies! Maybe we can better detect magical potential among the troops!

—Ye-yeah! Tha-that's the idea— he lied. —Whenever we went on missions there, your teleportation seemed specially powerful, so I thought…

—It's perfect, Bow. You can go as soon as you want— she smiled.

—Thanks…

Part of him felt *so* bad for lying to her, but it was *necessary*.

He was sure he could find more about Glimmer's actual powers there in the Woods.

Black magic was *not* a power she should wield, but the teleportation? The beams of light she could shoot out of her hands!? Those were her powers! He *knew it*!

He just needed to prove it to her.



And he would.

Truth

Bow saw a flash of purple and blue and knew those were princesses. The wind and nets ones, he was sure.

So he had to *run*.

It didn't matter where, just far from them.

Glimmer was not with him this time, he couldn't fight them with arrows, of which he had only two left, and there was no way those two soldiers accompanying him could do much either.

Why did he have to do this!?

Yeah, he had doubts, he wanted to investigate alone, but… he should have known it was going to be difficult without Glimmer to help him.

His thoughts were still reeling, getting louder to the point he hardly paid any attention to his surroundings, and soon enough, he tripped and fell.

Everything went black.

When Bow opened his eyes again, he couldn't recognize where he was.

There were strange figures on the ground, which was definitely not soil, maybe some sort of strange metal…

Yet around him there were trees, so he had to be in the Whispering Woods still…

And then he saw a pair of men.

Yelping, he reached for his arrows and pulled back the bowstring.

If needed, he could shoot both arrows and kill them both…

But something made him hesitate.

Instead of shooting, he asked —Who are you!?

—We-we… are archeologists— one of them replied, looking scared yet seemingly making an effort not to backtrack.

The other man looked more firm, as if refusing to cower.

—Who are *you*!?— he asked, defiant.

—I-I am- I am…

—What's your name?— the scared man asked, something shining in his eyes which Bow could not comprehend.

—It doesn't matter— he replied, forcing himself to stop stammering. He then stood up, arrows still ready to shoot, bowstring pulled taut. —I have one question for you: What do you know about Hordak and Bright Moon?

—He's an invader— the defiant man immediately replied. —The Kingdom was taken over by him, and now Etheria is suffering for it.

—He said he wanted to unify Etheria.

—Does it look unified to you!? Who *are* you, Boy?

—I am Hordak's apprentice— he finally revealed. Pulling tighter, ready to be attacked, he added —My name is Bow.

—Bo-Bow!?— the men both repeated, shocked.

—You are…— the scared man began, stepping closer, which made Bow react by aiming at him.

—Don't come closer!

—Easy, Bow. We-we *know you*— the other one said.

—No, that's impossible.

—What do you know about your parents?— he asked, defiant once more.

—They are dead. I never knew them. The Princesses killed them.

—Only one of those things is true.

—Lies!— Bow insisted, aiming at him now, hesitant and feeling a knot in his throat, but afraid to be walking into a trap.

—It is not. Bow, please, listen to us!— the scared man pleaded, seemingly on the verge of tears. —Your parents are alive… but, it was *you* who supposedly died.

—How!?

—Your home was attacked when you were a baby. The princesses *saved* your parents and siblings… but couldn't save you in time— he explained, voice about to break. —You were taken by Hordak's officers, and… and, everyone thought you died…

—Prove it. Where are my parents!?

—Right here, Bow— he sobbed. Taking a step forward, he added —It's us.

—No.

—It is— he insisted, tears on his eyes.

—No!

—Please, my Boy…

—*No*!

On instinct, and because he wouldn't stop approaching, Bow's grip on the arrows slipped, and both flew at great speed.

One went right between the men. The other… sank into the approaching man and knocked him back.

—Lance!

Bow gasped as he saw the defiant man immediately undone on the ground next to the other one.

He felt breathless.

He never intended to…

—It was… my mistake— Lance uttered, a weak smile on his lips. —But it must… be him. There's… no mistake.

—But, but… you're…

—It's okay…— Lance sighed.

What had he done!?

Had he killed a man!?

Was that really his father!?

Had he killed *his own father*!?

Letting the bow fall, he carefully approached, hands raised, saying —I-I didn't mean to… to shoot. I-I'm sorry.

—I know…— Lance said, still struggling to breathe. —Don't give him… that look, George.

Bow was ready to see a mess of blood on his chest, yet when he finally arrived next to the men, under George's stern gaze, there was none.

—Wait, is he…

—He's not hurt.

—How!?

—You really didn't mean to shoot, did you?

—No, I swear, I didn't… The arrows slipped from my fingers.

—Alright— George accepted, albeit reluctanct. —This is what happened— he explained, pulling out the arrow before taking out a notebook from a pocket on Lance's chest. —He always carries this with him… and *that*, is you.

Bow took the open notebook, now pierced by the arrow, and looked at the drawing of a baby boy that had almost been destroyed.

Yes, that… seemed to be him.

—You… are my fathers?

—Somehow— Lance weakly laughed. —This hurts… still. Neither of us could… ever be so lethal — he joked.

—How can you still- Ah… Let's get you back inside before someone else finds us— George sighed, evidently used to this behaviour from him.

—Let me help— Bow requested.

—Should we…

—Of course!— Lance immediately reacted, before wincing in pain. —Please?

—Fine… You can help us— George accepted. —But grab your bow; if you leave it there, someone might find us.

As Bow helped the men into the ruins, they explained how they had fled and made a little safe-haven in there; the place actually looked like a cottage inside. They also told him how they had raised their children there, and then they had all left to find their own place in Etheria, as far or as close to the war as they wanted…

But for them, as archeologist, those ruins were the perfect place to live and never leave, so they remained there.

—What about food and drinks? Where do you get your necessities?

—We're friends with some princesses who usually bring us whatever we may need— George explained, while checking Lance's chest. —Well, you, my Love, are lucky. That notebook saved you— he finally said. —It will probably hurt for a while more, but at least you don't even have a scratch.

—You have impressive aim, Bow— Lance said, making him blush.

—I've trained since I was little…

—What else did the Horde told you?

—A lot… a lot of things.

They exchanged a glance and George commented —But you seem… hesitant.

—I am here because I was doubting, yes— Bow admitted. —My friend, Glimmer, since her mother disappeared, she's been mentored by her aunt, and… I think she never really told her the truth.

—Her aunt…

—Must be Micah's sister— Lance pointed out.

—She's alive?

—Apparently.

—Yeah, she is— Bow confirmed. —You thought she had died?

—As far as *we* know. She disappeared from Mystacor long ago, but…

—I don't know much about her, I won't lie, but… I think- I think she's been trying to raise Glimmer to be… like her.

—That doesn't sound like a good thing.

—It isn't— Bow confirmed, giving Lance a serious look. —Castaspella taught her dark magic, it's a form of sorcery that corrupts the body. Glimmer still looks normal, but I fear, if she keeps using it, she'll end up like her aunt, visibly corrupted, maybe even mentally— he expressed. —I've already noticed changes in her…

—What made you doubt what you knew?— George asked, curious.

—Glimmer's been… unrecognizable lately— he admitted. —I helped her overthrow Hordak, then she took charge, and… nothing changed. She's just… like Hordak.

—You do understand she's a princess, right?

—Yes, but… we've been taught princesses are evil and… Ca-can I ask about that new princess?

—New- You mean She-Ra?

—Yes— Bow nodded. —Since she appeared, Glimmer's determination changed and that's why we overthrew Hordak. We thought he was being- well, incompetent. We were supposed to make things right, but… I don't know.

—She-Ra is a legendary warrior who returned now because we needed her— Lance explained. —She protects Etheria when it loses balance.

—So we- the Horde, aren't… I knew it— Bow sighed. —I should have done something earlier.

—You're doing something *now*— George reminded him. —This… it's something I never imagined… seeing you again. But you're here.

—Please stay for a meal— Lance requested, sitting up with a bit of pain. —Tell us more about yourself, Son.

"Son", he called him.

He never thought he'd hear that word…

Hesitant for a moment, Bow looked back at the exit and took a deep breath.

—Yeah, of course— he accepted.

A bit later, the three had just finished eating when a couple showed up.

—Knock, knock! Hey, we brought… Woah, who's he!?

Bow turned around, immediately jumped back when he saw the Princesses, and reached for his arrows, which he had none of.

—Hey, hey, calm down, Son— Lance gently told him, reaching up to him from his seat. —They are friends. She's Netossa, and behind her, Spinnerella, her wife.

—"Son"? But…

—Wait, Netty… That can't be, right?

—That's what I'm saying!

—Well, it *is* right!— Lance happily said.

—This is Bow, our son— George confirmed.

—But, how!? I thought… When I couldn't find him…— Spinnerella began, tearing up.

—Spinny, it's alright. We always told you that you weren't to blame— Lance reminded her.

—But how is he here now!?

—He found us— George smiled.

—Where were you?— Netossa asked, confused.

—I… was in the Horde. In Bright Moon— he replied, looking down, now a bit calmer.

—The- But…

—I am- *was* Hordak's apprentice.

—They raised you!?— the princesses exclaimed in unison.

—Maybe I should leave already— Bow sighed.

—No, no! No way!— Lance refused. —My Love, talk some sense into him!

—Listen, Son, you are welcome here. Alright? Regardless of who raised you, you're here with us now. And you will always belong here…

Belong.

—Thanks…— he weakly smiled.

—Alright, wait, I need to let *everyone* know about this— Netossa laughed.

—Hold on— Bow stopped her, looking at them with less shame than before. —I would- Could I speak with… the-the leaders of the Rebellion?

—I- Why?— Spinnerella curiously asked.

—I want this war to end. I need their help for that.

—We can arrange that, right?— she asked Netossa.

—Sure, we can… ask some people to come and speak with you.

—Thank you. I promise I have no weapons. I ran out of arrows and have no other dangerous skills — Bow assured them.

—Thanks, Kid. Don't worry, though, even with arrows, the people we're gonna call would have no trouble— Netossa smirked.

Less than an hour later, three women showed up at the ruins, Bow's fathers prepared some tea for them and Bow, then left with Netossa and Spinnerella to give them some privacy.

Two girls around Bow's age and an older woman with a veil had shown up.

He knew the old woman, Light Spinner. But the girls…

—I- Sorry, uh, I recognize you, Light Spinner, but… who are you two?— Bow asked, clearing his throat.

—General Catra and Commander Adora— the sorceress replied. —*They* are the leaders of the Rebellion.

—Oh… I-I apologize. I didn't mean…

—No offense taken— Catra quickly denied. —You're not a soldier, it's clear.

—Why did you want to speak to us?— Adora then asked.

—I need… Well, I- Ah… I don't know how to explain it— he sighed. —Have you heard of Glimmer? Angella's daughter?

—Yes— the girls nodded.

—I need to save her— he explained. —She's… changed. I mean, her aunt did something to her, and… Well, not something- I mean, she's been mentoring Glimmer, and now I feel like I'm about to lose my best friend, and I can't let that happen— he let out, breathless.

—Woah, calm down, Man…— Catra told him, surprised.

—Can you explain what you mean?— Adora inquired.

—It's a *lot*. Like, really a lot.

—I don't think we have the time right now— Light Spinner pointed out.

—True— Catra agreed. —So just, tell us: How can *we* help? I don't think you want us to storm the palace, right?

—No, that's the thing. I need your help, but not attacking. I think I can still solve this and make Glimmer see she's taking the wrong path. But… I will need some help with two things— Bow explained. —First, I need someone to keep Castaspella busy. Or at least distracted. Just, don't hurt her because she's all the family Glimmer has left.

—I disagree with that last point, but I can handle that myself— Light Spinner assured him.

—What else?— Adora then asked.

—Second, I'll need you to be open to making a truce with Glimmer.

—You think she'll *want* that!?— Catra scoffed, disbelieving.

—I will convince her. I think I can… I hope…

—Look, if you *do* manage it, then yes, we'll be open to negotiation— Adora promised. —But if there's *any* sign of danger, if she threatens us in any way, I cannot guarantee her safety, so you better make sure she *really* wants to fix things.

—I will— Bow nodded, determined.

—In that case, I'll prepare a few things and go to Bright Moon tonight. If you open the way for me, I'll take care of Castaspella while you talk with Glimmer— Light Spinner told him.

—Deal.

—Then we'll get going— Adora nodded. —Good afternoon— she farewelled, followed by Catra and Light Spinner.

A moment after they left, Bow's fathers and the princesses walked back in.

—Everything alright?— Spinnerella asked.

—Perfect— he smiled. —Thank you for the help.

—Anytime, Kid— Netossa smiled.

Later, as the sun began setting, Bow prepared to leave and walked out of the ruins.

—Wait, Son, where are you going!?

—Back to Bright Moon.

—What!? No! We-we just got you back!— Lance panicked.

—I can't abandon Glimmer… I *know* she's been corrupted and all, but… I *can't*.

—You love her, don't you?— George asked, placing a hand on his shoulder.

—Yes… Dad.

—Then go. But you better come back to us!— Lance told him.

—I will— he smiled. Then, hugging them both, he added —I am excited to get to know you better.

—And you will— George nodded. —Now go, rescue your Princess.

Sorcery

As Bow stepped into the palace of the Horde, he felt chills.

Everything was so quiet.

The world had completely changed for him, but for everyone else… everything was the same.

He couldn't stand it.

So Bow went for a new quiver of arrows, just in case, and began sprinting.

After unlocking a back-entrance and letting Light Spinner inside, he pointed her towards Castaspella's chamber and then rushed the opposite way.

He needed to see something.

He was hopeful, but he needed to make sure there *was* hope behind the dull, cold metal.

As he arrived at the Throne room, he almost tripped on his own feet as he found someone lazily lying on the throne.

—Evening, Bow… You're still alive.

Oh… He had sent the sorceress the wrong way.

—Why-why wouldn't I be?

—You were out the whole day. None of the soldiers who went with you returned… Here I thought you had *perished*— Castaspella admitted.

Bow didn't like this at all.

Especially they way she rested on the throne like it was hers…

—You would have wanted that, I'm sure— he defiantly replied.

Where did that come from!?

Oh, no…

Good thing he went for his arrows beforehand.

—Maybe— Castaspella smirked. —It wouldn't be easy to deal with Glimmer's grief, but I'm sure I could… still handle that— she then added, rising her fingers to let a spark of black magic trail between them.

The message was clear.

—Well, I am *not* dead. So you can save that.

—Or I can *fix that*— she laughed, standing up in a single move before shooting his way.

Fine!

He'd have to do this himself.

Rolling out of the way just in time, he quickly prepared a couple of arrows and shot one after the other.

As expected, Castaspella deflected them all, and attacked again.

But Bow was ready with a fourth arrow, and jumped out of the way while shooting, taking Castaspella by surprise and piercing her extended arm.

As she yelled and fell to the ground, he prepared one last arrow and aimed.

—I'm not as defenseless and useless as you may think— he began. —So stop. Stop this madness, already— he pleaded. —Make things *right*!

With a laugh, almost maniacal, Castaspella shook her head.

—You don't know what you're talking about…

—Then I have no choice— he sentenced, pulling the bowstring taut. —I'm not letting you further corrupt Glimmer.

—We'll see…— she groaned, before teleporting away with black magic. She appeared just outside Glimmer's room, where she knew her niece was, and began exaggeratedly whining. —Glimmer, my Dear, don't come out.

—A-Auntie!?

—No, no, stay in there— she insisted.

—What!? Wait, no, what happened!? Isn't that… one of Bow's arrows!?

—He's out of control, Dear. He's trying to destroy the Throne room! I was so glad he had returned, but he's out of his mind!— she lied. —Don't go, stay here! I don't want him to hurt you…

—No! I'll fix this, Auntie. I-I know he would never hurt me. I can…

—But Glimmer, what if he…

—Don't worry, Auntie— she interrupted. —I can handle myself. You go rest— she insisted, immediately blinking away.

With her gone, Castaspella stood straight again, smirking to herself, and calmly headed for her chamber.

Glimmer appeared right outside the Throne room.

She couldn't believe what her aunt told her, but at the same time… he *had* been away all day.

So she first took a peek.

Bow seemed to be panicking for a moment, before suddenly letting his weapon fall and reaching for the wall. He pulled and pulled until he tore off a metal plaque.

Seeing the marble underneath sparked something inside Glimmer's mind that completely blinded her.

—What do you think you're doing!?— she yelled, barging inside.

She wasn't thinking at all.

She needed answers…

But the more he tried to explain, the less she could understand.

And then he called her a *princess*!

On instinct, she denied being like them, and he said —No… You're not… Because you're not even the Glimmer I know. *My friend* would never… threaten me.

That was when she saw her hands glowing.

She was really… thinking about hurting him!?

No. She was not *thinking*.

What was this!?

What was she doing?

This… wasn't *her*!

She would never treat Bow like this!

Why was she…

Oh, of course.

It was all *her* fault.

Her so-called *Aunt*…

She had lied earlier, hadn't she?

—Bow. Tell me everything— she ordered. —What happened when you were away?

—I found my fathers.

—What!?

—Listen, Glim. We were lied to— he began. —My parents weren't killed by princesses, they were *saved* by them! I-I even have siblings!

—Ma-maybe Hordak lied to you, but Auntie…

—No, Glim, she's been lying too— he insisted. —I wasn't told the whole story, but they thought she was dead… and… I-I don't know. I'm sure they can tell you better…

—Who's "they"? Did you bring the Alliance…

—I didn't— he quickly clarified. —I asked them to give you a chance. But I did- I brought Light Spinner to deal with your aunt.

—Bow!

—She'll be fine!

—And if she isn't!?

—She's been lying to you and turned you into someone I don't recognize!— he pointed out. —She doesn't deserve your concern.

—But…

—But she *will* be alright— Bow finally nodded, somehow sure of it. —I don't think Light Spinner wants her dead.

—I still need to go.

—Alright. Go. I'll catch up soon— Bow promised.

She had no idea what she would find when she appeared, but just in case, Glimmer showed up with a fist ready.

And she was right.

She had to shoot right before Castaspella struck Light Spinner down with a deadly attack.

She couldn't let her kill the person who had *answers*.

Now, her aunt was on the ground, a few meters away from Light Spinner, right under a window.

—You lied to me!— she began, striding closer to her "Auntie". —Didn't you!?

—Glimmer?— a male voice let out.

She felt numb for a moment before turning around.

—Dad!?— she noticed, immediately blinking closer to him, forgetting everything else. —Dad…— she sobbed, hugging him tightly.

How had she not noticed him before?

Her memories of him were almost gone, too faint to feel real. But now he was there, hugging her, and it all recovered it's strength.

He was back.

But Glimmer could hardly enjoy the moment.

—Ah… so I lied, didn't I?— Castaspella uttered, pushing herself up from the ground. —And now they are back to save the day, and I lose… again…— she went on, standing up.

—Casta, wait, you never had to…

—Yes, I had!— she barked, interrupting her brother. —But worry not, Micah. That won't be a problem anymore.

—What?

—No, wait!— Light Spinner yelled.

She wouldn't… right?

With a wicked smirk, Castaspella took a step back, then another, and leant back against nothing, letting herself fall out of the window.

Of course she would…

Rolling her eyes, Glimmer blinked away and reappeared a second later, with Castaspella prone under her.

—You are *not* taking the easy way out, *Auntie*. You made me into this, and now you'll face the consequences— she hissed, summoning her powers.

—Wait, wait! Glimmer!— Micah called, grabbing her wrists and pulling her back.

—Let her! Let's see how well I taught her!— Castaspella yelled, laughing maniacally.

—Shut up!— Light Spinner ordered, taking Glimmer's place holding her down.

—Or what!? You'll kill me instead!? No, let Glimmer do it! She was *raised for this*!— she taunted.

—Stop!— the Head Sorceress insisted.

—Glimmer, please— Micah calmly told his daughter, who struggled to get free and kept yelling at Castaspella she would kill her.

—Wow…— Bow uttered, arriving at the chamber.

He was… not expecting that.

—Quick! Calm her down!— Light Spinner ordered, looking back at Bow for a second.

—Hey, hey… Glim, it's okay— he began, kneeling next to Micah and Glimmer. He didn't recognize the King at first, but as soon as he did, his face turned red. Yet the sorcerer only nodded at him and Bow took a deep breath before hugging Glimmer. —Forget her.

—I want her *dead*!

—No, Glim, you don't… You want her to *pay*.

—Yes!— she nodded, hugging him tightly.

—And she will, but only if she's alive.

—I don't want… to lose anyone else…— Glimmer sobbed.

—I know, I know— he hummed, caressing her hair. —You won't. I can promise you, this is it.

However, as Glimmer cried in his shoulder, Castaspella rolled her eyes and searched for a way out.

—How pathetic!— she complained. —And here I thought I had done a better *job*!— she laughed, before summoning all the black magic she could. —Now get off me! If you won't kill me, then I'm not sitting here to *wait*.

Right after, Light Spinner began crying in pain.

It burnt her. It burnt so bad…

—Stop!

—I won't! So either let go or *burn with me*.

—No!— the sorceress yelled, holding tighter onto Castaspella. —I'm not letting you hurt anyone else. I'm not letting you hurt your brother again.

—Hypocrite!

—Yes! I'm a hypocrite! But I'm not letting go!— Light Spinner insisted. —Stay away, Micah!— she ordered, feeling movement behind her. —Listen, Casta, listen… You're right to hate me. It was all my fault… But we owe Micah… better…— she told her, struggling against the pain, gasping for air more and more as the pain consumed her.

Bow held Glimmer tighter as he saw marks of corruption extend through Light Spinner's skin. His worst fear for Glimmer. And when he looked down at her, she was staring in horror.

—Why? Why won't you… give up?— Castaspella whined, still burning herself and the Head Sorceress with dark magic.

—Giving up on you led to this. I won't let it happen again— she sentenced.

With that, something shifted inside Castaspella.

She stopped resisting, dismissed the black magic, and lost all strength.

—Will Glimmer… be alright? Will she be safe?— the dark sorceress asked, looking up at the roof.

—I give you my word.

—Alright…— she sighed, and closed her eyes, giving up.

—A-Auntie?— Glimmer called, confused herself, but feeling immense terror at the idea of her being dead.

—She's fine, just ran out of energy— Light Spinner confirmed, summoning magical shackles for her. —Are you alright, Glimmer?

—I… think. Dad?

—How I missed hearing that word— Micah admitted, cupping Glimmer's face.

—What happened? Where were you!?

—I think we should tell her everything, Micah— Light Spinner sighed, still sitting on the floor next to Castaspella, who was little by little regaining her strength and trying to sit too. —Starting with your "disappearance", of course. That will explain why your sister ended up… like this.

Micah glanced away for a moment, ashamed, and only looked back to say —It was all for nothing. I caused this, and now you are…

Yet she raised her hand to interrupt him and shook her head.

—It had to be done. And now it is done. We'll figure it out— she insisted, completely dismissing the fact that she was now covered in corruption marks. —But it's important that our young princess here gets answers.

—I-I'm not…

—Glim, you *are* a princess— Bow reminded her. —Just listen to them— he exhorted her with a gentle smile. —I'm curious too— he then muttered, giggling.

—My girl… your mother… When Angella gave Hordak control over the Moonstone… she was expecting something different— Micah began. —You weren't even born yet, she was vulnerable, it seemed like the right choice to keep his power on our side, where you'd be safe… But then, you *were* born and, as you grew, negotiating with Hordak became more difficult. Your mother was bolder— he went on, looking down. —I went to Light Spinner, to ask for help, and she… well, she was performing a powerful spell that supercharged us. That meant I returned as a threat to Hordak's power… I tried to hide it for a while, but eventually, it became impossible. So I had to disappear— he explained. —I didn't think your mother would have much trouble dealing with him afterwards, but then I learnt- I can't, Light Spinner. Please…

—Glimmer. When your father fled, your mother sought Castaspella's help to raise you. But she didn't know what your aunt had been going through the past few years, and…

—It was me. I got rid of your mother— Castaspella admitted, voice faint. —I thought she was weak. She couldn't protect Micah, I thought him dead for the same reason I had been cast aside… She fled from *me*.

—I don't understand…

—The spell I performed… It supercharged most sorcerers, but not everyone— Light Spinner explained. —Your father was there by mere chance, and got the extra power… Castaspella, on the other hand, *was* supposed to be there, but… she didn't get the boost of power for some reason.

—They searched for a solution for years, while I was here trying to stay out of Hordak's radar… So I didn't know, but Casta soon turned to… black magic— Micah explained.

—After some time, I told her to give up. *I* gave up… She didn't— Light Spinner sighed.

—It is not easy being the only person who is *not enough* for anything— Castaspella scoffed. —Black magic offered me what I had been denied. Then Micah disappeared, I presumed Mystacor had turned its back on him, and I thought your mother would raise you in fear. I couldn't let that happen…

—You couldn't have known— Glimmer rebuked.

—No, she would…— Micah admitted. —I knew it too, but after learning Casta was raising you, and what she had become, I didn't want to return until I had a way to undo the damage black magic had done— he explained. —That's why I didn't return. I wouldn't dare to. But, if I had, maybe everything would have been different.

—Dad… Why wait?

—I was… afraid.

—A-and what about Mom? What happened to her?

—The Princesses know where she is, but they won't tell me— he explained. —They say I can't reach her, and knowing where she is would only make things more difficult for me.

—So, Mom is out there too… Everyone has always *been there*, but none of you ever tried to reach out!?— Glimmer exclaimed, standing up. —You just-just let Auntie do this to me!?— she went on, holding her head, starting to feel intense pain.

She was crying.

—What's happening?— Bow asked, reaching towards Glimmer but not daring to touch her.

—How twisted is her mind already!?— Micah asked, glaring at Castaspella.

—She resisted it more than me— she replied, a bit defiant. —So, go ahead, save your daughter.

Micah had no idea what that meant, but acted on instinct and embraced Glimmer tightly.

—I'm here, Baby. I won't leave you again— he muttered. —I'm here…

Glimmer kept crying, but the pain, the resistance of her mind, it was receding.

—I won't… I-I won't… use black magic… again… I swear— she promised, holding her father tightly.

—It's alright. You'll be alright— Micah replied, caressing her hair.

It took her another moment to calm down, but she eventually did.

—I'll make things right, for real this time— she decided, brushing away her tears. She gave Bow a resolute nod, and he smirked back, encouraging. —Oh, and I want you to help Aunt Casta. I don't know if you found a way to fix the corruption, Dad, but I… wouldn't want to have her imprisoned forever.

—Don’t worry, I found it. And I don’t want to abandon her either…

—You don’t deserve help— she began, facing Castaspella. —But I refuse to be the way you raised me… so you *are* getting help. And if, one day, regret eats you from the inside, then it’ll be punishment enough.

Princess Glimmer

Dark magic wasn't the only thing Castaspella taught her.

Fortunately.

Otherwise, she would have had to use it again for what came next…

But no. Her aunt had also taught Glimmer proper sorcery, safe sorcery, and she didn't hesitate to use every spell she could recall to aid her in the new mission: getting rid of the Horde's pollution and restoring Bright Moon's palace to it's former glory.

She'd deal with everything else later.

First, she needed things to go back to how it all was before her mother disappeared.

Glimmer could still feel the tug of black magic in her mind, and the memories of her childhood, her father, Bow, those things helped her stay in control.

So what could be better than restoring her environment to how it was before her first taste of corruption?

Besides, Glimmer had a *lot* of pent up anger she needed to release, and tearing off metal from the walls proved to be quite useful for that.

It took her all night, but eventually, every piece of metal that had been added over the palace's original structure was finally gone, along with the experimental devices attached to the runestone.

At last…

Glimmer stood on top of the Moonstone's pillar, feeling its power pure and clean for the first time, and watching the restored palace as the sun came up.

—It's beautiful…— she sighed, feeling at ease.

—Glim— a voice called her from behind.

—Bow— she smiled. —How did it go?

—Many of the cadets were actually happy to leave— he began. —The higher ranking officers, on the other hand, showed some resistance, but there were some former guards of the palace among them, and they asked if they could maybe go back to their original jobs if the Royal Guard was restored, so I said they could. We *will* need them, I think— he explained, scratching the back of his neck. —Did I do right?

—Of course— she nodded, approaching to hug him. —What about the… other thing we discussed?

—Oh, yeah… I think you will first need to make a truce with the Princess Alliance and the Rebellion… Then *maybe* they will agree to restoring your crown— he smirked.

—Oh…

—Don’t worry, Glim. I spoke to them before and they said they would be open to giving you a chance, alright?

—Right…— she sighed. —Just… come with me, yes?

—At your service.

Bow told her to rest a bit before her first meeting with the Princess Alliance and the Rebellion, but she simply couldn’t.

She was too nervous.

All this time, cursing their names… fantasizing with the idea of submitting them to her power… And now she had to forget about all that and make a truce? Probably even shake their hands!?

Yes, Bow told her, but she still couldn’t believe they would ever give her a chance.

It had to be… a trap.

What if her aunt was right, after all?

What if she had been tricked?

No, no! That was… that was *her* talking!

She had to do this.

She *would* do this.

Eventually, she heard Bow knocking on the door asking if she was awake, that it was time to go.

No, she was not ready; far from it, as a matter of fact, but…

He was encouraging.

—We can leave at any moment if you decide so. You don’t have to “endure” the meeting, alright? If you feel uncomfortable, attacked, judged, whatever, just say the word and we leave.

—Thank you— she smiled. —That’s actually very reassuring— she admitted. —I’m afraid.

—I know— he sighed, hugging her close. —I’ll be by your side the whole time.

Right. He would be there…

She had to trust in him.

The place chosen for the meeting was up in the floating island of Mystacor.

Glimmer had to hold back from asking Light Spinner about her aunt; she was worried, but also *so* angry.

She decided against asking about her because she realized part of her hoped she was *not* doing alright at all…

Instead, she focused solely on why she was there, and avoided any conversations that led to discussing Castaspella.

With help from her father and the Head Sorceress, Glimmer eventually managed to reach an agreement with the Princesses and the leaders of the Rebellion.

—A month or two of trial. We may shorten or prolong the time as we see fit according to your behaviour. *And* only if you demonstrate your change of heart, then we will let you know where your mother is— a tall, blonde princess told her. She could almost feel the power emanating from her. That had to be the first time she was so close to She-Ra. —Any questions?

—Why do *you* know where my mom is, and why do you keep it a secret even from Dad?— Glimmer decided to ask, genuinely confused.

—From him, because he can't reach her. Knowing where she is would only hurt him— the Princess began. Then, looking away and seemingly sorrowful, she suddenly transformed into a well-known Rebellion commander. Glimmer had no idea… they were one and the same. —With you, however, we must be careful because your aunt was the one who- Ah… We just need to be sure you aren't secretly trying to finish what Castaspella started.

—N-no! I would never hurt my mom! I want to see her!

With a mix of rage and pain, Glimmer tried and failed to remain calm; her fists closed tightly and she was almost sure she was glowing, with her powers threatening to lose control.

—Easy, Sparkles— General Catra stopped her. —As she said, we can't be sure until you prove it. And trust me, your mother is not going anywhere, so you have plenty of time to demonstrate you aren't like your aunt.

—You have *no right*!— she cried, breathless.

—As a matter of fact, we do— Commander Adora replied. —She entrusted us with the task of taking care of her until you… were ready to see her again.

—You can't keep being this ominous…— Glimmer complained. But what could she do about it!? So many years under her aunt's tutelage made her instincts far from the best path to follow. —Fine. I won't- I'll show you I'm *not* like Aunt Casta. I just want to see my mother…

—I promise you that this is the right choice. We already spoke with Bow, he assured us your heart still remains intact. But we must protect the Queen, do you understand?

—I understand— she nodded, holding Adora's sight.

—Good, then. We just need to define the matter of the supervisor, and we can all return to our duties— General Catra pointed out. —If you chose the King as your supervisor, that means you'd

still have to answer to Head Sorceress Light Spinner. Is that clear?

—Isn't that the same as her being my supervisor directly?

—Yes, and no. She can't be your supervisor because she's already in charge of Castaspella. Normally, King Micah would suffice, but since he's your father, we need a second opinion to make sure he isn't putting in a good word for you just because of your relationship— the magicat explained.

—I see… Yeah, sure. I'm alright with that. I-I understand— Glimmer accepted.

—Good. Either Adora or I will be visiting every week too, we'll talk with the King and with Light Spinner. We may also interview people of the palace if we think it's necessary. Do you accept these terms?

—Why the- Why would you interview the people of the palace?

—To get more opinions, to know how the people see you, how you treat them…

—Fine— Glimmer groaned. —I accept.

—Perfect, then. That's all.

As General Catra and Commander Adora exchanged glances and nodded to the acolytes standing guard, the doors to the chamber where they were discussing were opened and Bow was allowed inside.

—How did it go?— he asked, not particularly worried.

Glimmer was going to wait until everyone left to reply, but instead, the leaders of the Rebellion spoke to him as if they were friends.

—She's all yours, Arrow Boy. Take care.

—Good, it went good— the Commander nodded, with a friendly smile. —See you at the end of the week.

As Bow chuckled, seemingly relieved, Glimmer stared in shock.

—Can we go back home?— she finally forced herself to ask, trying not to sound too angry.

—Oh- uh, sure, Glim. Let's go— he nodded, offering her his hand.

Glimmer took a deep breath before grabbing it, and immediately teleported them both directly to Bright Moon's palace. As they appeared in the Throne Room, she let go of his hand and turned around, feeling ashamed already.

—You're friends with them?— she asked, bracing for impact.

—Uh, kind of. I spoke to them when I met my parents, convinced them to give you a chance, and… since you were so nervous today, I spoke with them again before we went to the meeting.

—So now you're all buddy-buddy with them?— she insisted, turning around to give him a pained look, on the verge of tears.

—Wow, Glim, what's the problem!?— he asked back, concerned, rushing to hug her tight. —I thought befriending them might help you. They aren't bad people like we were led to think…

—I-I'm just…

Jealous.

But she couldn't say that.

Yet it was unnecessary.

As if guessing it, he released her and carefully cupped her face, making her look up at him, and told her —I'm not going anywhere, Glim.

—But… what if…

—There's no what if that could make me leave you— he interrupted. —I'm staying with you— he insisted, kissing her forehead.

—Why?— she then asked, letting her tears fall.

With a gentle smile, he simply replied —Because I love you.

—Huh? You…— she uttered, trailing off as he nodded. —Really?

—Absolutely— he laughed, hugging her again. —Don't you trust me?

—Of course— she sobbed, hugging him back tightly. —You should have told me sooner…

—Yeah, probably— he admitted, with a sad smile. —But I wasn't sure if the *you* I love was… still there.

—Am I?

—You are— he confirmed. —I didn't lose you— he added, making her laugh.

—Do you think I can prove it? That I can… see Mom again?

—I think so, yes— Bow replied, confident. —They just need time to see in you what I do.

—Thanks…

—Don't thank me, Glim.

—Alright— she accepted, throwing her arms around his neck and tiptoeing to kiss him instead.

Finally, the time arrived.

The Princess Alliance revealed Angella's location at last…

Could Glimmer do it? See her mother again? Face her, after the way she had behaved, the dark magic she had used… after losing her path?

She wasn't sure.

She hadn't even considered the possibility that her mother was still alive… And it ashamed her.

How had she allowed her aunt to twist her mind so much?

Enough to forget her own mother…

No.

She never forgot her.

But she neglected her memory…

She had to do this.

Her father and the Princesses said she was "unreachable" for him, and didn't explain what that meant. But the Alliance also claimed Glimmer maybe could…

Why weren't they explaining more!?

It angered her, and every time she got angry, she could feel the last vestige of black magic try to revive.

So she took a deep breath, calmed down, and thanked the messenger.

Right after, she went to look for Bow. She'd need him by her side.

And she had to go as soon as possible, before she could think too much about it.

—Bow?— she called, walking into his room.

—Oh, hey, Glim. Everything alright?

—I just received a messenger from the Princess Alliance.

—The location!?— he guessed, hopeful.

—Yes. Would you…

—Let me look it up in my track-pad— he offered.

—Su-sure.

Tinkering a bit with it, he input the coordinates she had been sent, and finally looked up at her.

—That's… here in Bright Moon.

—How!?

—Look— he said, showing her the map. —That's the strange underground network of tunnels we investigated with Hordak.

—But the entrance is sealed— she reminded him.

—Maybe not to you— he suggested. —Perhaps that's why your dad can't reach her but you can.

—Oh…— Glimmer sighed. —I- Ca-can you come with me?— she finally asked, giving him a pleading look.

—Of course!— he smiled. —I'm pretty curious about those tunnels— Bow admitted, blushing a bit.

With a playful smirk, she mocked him —Nerd…

—When are we going?

—I'd rather go now, if you don't mind— she admitted, looking away and rubbing her hands nervously. —I just hope… she won't… be disappointed in me.

—Glim, I'm sure she won't. You've been working to fix everything you did wrong, and… to be honest, we didn't even *know* we were wrong, to begin with— he reminded her, placing a hand on her shoulder. —Don't be scared.

But she knew she wouldn't be scared with him by her side.

Reassured, Princess Glimmer took his hand and they both teleported to the approximate location of the mysterious underground tunnels.

Just as Bow predicted, her presence was enough to let them inside and, soon, they were exploring the tunnel network, illuminated by his flashlight.

—Do you think she's really here?— Glimmer finally asked, after a while of wandering aimlessly.

—I don't see why they would lie to you about the location…

—It could be a trap. Maybe they don't trust me yet, and what if…

—Hey, calm down, Glim. I'm sure they trust you. We just need to keep searching— he encouraged her. —Maybe just follow your instincts?

—I don't know how to do that…

—I guess we could- Oh, damn, the flashlight is dead— he complained, as it suddenly began blinking and finally turned off.

—Should I teleport us back?— Glimmer asked, right before the tunnel's darkness receded. —Wow…

Crystals.

There were glowing crystals illuminating the tunnel.

Like a path.

—Why don't we… follow that?

—And if it leads to a dead end?— she asked back.

—Then we return. We lose nothing trying— Bow pointed out.

—Alright…

Holding onto his arm, not wanting to admit she was scared and, part of her, hoping it *would* lead to a dead end, Glimmer walked with him, following the trail of glowing crystals.

It took them a while, but eventually, they reached a large area, like a chamber that could well be part of the palace.

—I can't believe this has been here all this time— Bow sighed, looking upwards, all around. —It's huge!

—She's not here— Glimmer uttered, letting go of him and approaching something like an short pillar at the back of the chamber, as if drawn to it. —Maybe she's really gone…

The Princess had such a turmoil inside, she didn't even notice herself placing a hand on top of the pillar until the surface lit up.

With a yelp, she jumped back and teleported next to Bow, grabbing onto him again. Instinctively, he covered her with his free arm, as they both watched the center of the chamber open.

In complete shock, they stared as a bright pink bubble floated up and the floor closed again. It remained hoovering just above the ground, solid pink for a moment before becoming translucid and letting them see what was inside.

Or rather, *who*.

—It's…

—Mom— Glimmer let out, tearing up.

Curled up, embracing her knees against her chest, and half covered by her wings, Queen Angella seemed in stasis, suspended in mid-air… and in time.

End Notes

I feel like this needs an ending note, but I don't know what to say so…

I hope you like this fic, please don't hate me too much for the ending XD and HERE is Tippen's post with the art again!!!!

Now yeah, thank you for reading and see you around maybe!!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!